DATADOG

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Follow the Attacker's Trail

Investigating a Real-life Cloud Incident

01 Application layer

Telemetry sources	HTTP requests, application logs
Datadog products	APM, Application Protection, Logs

What's the IP address that the attacker used to attack the web application? (IOC #1)

What kind of vulnerability did the attacker exploit in the web application?

02 Container layer

Telemetry sources Process and file activity

Datadog products Workload Protection

Which commands did the attacker run inside the container? For each command, write down the intent and impact for the incident response process.

Example: running "ls" has the intent of listing files, but no specific impact for incident response, while running "cat .credentials" has the intent of stealing credentials, and the impact that we'll need to rotate them to contain and remediate the incident.

Command	Intent	Impact

02 Container layer continued

How did the attacker establish persistence in the container?

What's the IP address of the server that the attacker used to stage a malicious bash script? (IOC #2)

What type of malware did the attacker deploy in the container?

03 Cloud layer

Telemetry sources	CloudTrail logs, AWS resources
Datadog products	Cloud SIEM, Logs, Cloud Security Management

A modern attack is often cross-layer, pivoting back and forth between applications and cloud environments.

How did the attacker establish persistence in the cloud environment?

What did the attacker exfiltrate from the cloud environment? How?

04 Incident scoping / blast radius

What misconfiguration is the domain-tester-service container affected by? What's the impact for containment and remediation of our incident?

What misconfiguration is the EC2 instance where the domain-tester-service runs affected by? What's the impact for containment and remediation of our incident?

In the previous section, you determined how the attacker persisted in the cloud environment. Did they use that persistence vector yet?

05 To do list for incident response

This table can help you write down actions to take for the containment and remediation process that will happen next.

Example: Asset type = IAM user, Asset name = test, Description = malicious IAM user, Action to take = remove.

Asset type	Asset name	Description	Action to take
IAM user	*test*	*Malicious IAM user*	*Remove*

06 Indicators of compromise

Description	Type	Value
Attacker IP exploiting the web application	IP address	
Attacker server staging the malicious bash script	IP address	
File name of the malicious bash script	File name	
File hash of the malicious bash script	File hash	
File path of the malicious binary	File path	
File hash of the malicious binary	File hash	

07 Timeline

Timestamp	Event	Description